

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Glossary of Terms

Week 2

1. **Noun:** A noun is a word that stands for someone or something in a sentence.
2. **Adjective:** An adjective is a word that modifies a noun.
3. **Definite article:** The word “the” in English. Almost all nouns in Greek are preceded by the definite article.
4. **Inflection:** When a noun changes its form to reflect subject, direct object, indirect object, or the possessive case.
5. **Declension:** There are three declensions in Koine Greek (first, second, and third declension). They are patterns of declining nouns, and affect how the endings of nouns change.
 - a. Most first declension nouns are feminine, ending with α or η.
 - b. Most second declension nouns are masculine, ending with ο.
 - c. Most third declension nouns are neuter, and they end with consonants.
6. **Case endings:** There are four case endings. Nouns decline according to a set of case endings which reveal their function in the sentence, e.g. subject, direct object, indirect object, or possessive case.
 - a. **Nominative:** the subject in the sentence, or subject of verb. The noun which is acting or performing the action.
 - b. **Accusative:** the direct object in the sentence, or the noun being acted upon.

- c. **Dative:** the indirect object in the sentence. It is the noun that is indirectly affected by the action of the verb.
- d. **Genitive:** the possessive case, used to indicate possession.